Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning with the City of Toronto. Researches policy questions, advises on by-laws and regulations, and writes the briefing notes and reports that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Advise applicants and staff on transportation planning, by-laws and related regulations, and with policy staff recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.
- Research policy questions as they come up, looking at how City policy, provincial legislation and work by other levels of government bear on them.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Policy research and analysis. Briefing notes, reports and presentations for senior staff. Coordination across divisions, agencies and consultants. Transportation data analysis. ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. Python and SQL.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022. CGPA 4.0/4.0; fully funded by the university.

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018. CGPA 3.69/4.0; University Merit Scholarship, University Stipend Scholarship, Technical Scholarship, Dean's List.

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)